

AMERICAN EXPRESS

ABOUT THE COMPANY:

American Express (Amex) is a global financial services company, best known for its premium credit cards, payment solutions, and customer service. Founded in 1850, it operates in over 130 countries and is ranked among the world's most valuable brands.

For professionals, Amex offers strong career opportunities in areas such as technology, analytics, finance, operations, risk management, and customer service. The company emphasizes career growth, learning programs, and a culture of inclusion and collaboration.

In India, American Express has a significant presence since 1921, with its largest center of excellence in Gurugram. Thousands of employees here contribute to global operations, innovation, and customer experience, making it an attractive workplace for those seeking growth in financial services and technology.

JOB ROLE

Intern/Apprentice – Technology – 8 weeks summer internship programme

ELIGIBILITY:

Minimum CGPA – 7, no active backlogs

1. Online test

The online test consisted of 3 coding questions and was conducted on codility platform.

Questions:

i) Given an array of integers. Find a subarray that starts and ends with the **same number** and has the **maximum possible sum**. Return that maximum sum.

ii) given a row of houses, each containing bags of different types of trash: **Metal (M)**, **Plastic (P)**, and **Glass (G)**. Distances between consecutive houses are given in array D, and the trash types at each house are given in array T.

Each type of trash has a dedicated truck that:

- Starts at the beginning,
- Travels to the farthest house containing its trash type,
- Collects bags (1 minute per bag),
- Returns to the starting point.

Task: Compute the total time needed until **all trucks finish collecting and return**, i.e., the maximum time among all trucks.

iii) Given an $n \times m$ grid with an assassin A, guards ($\wedge$ $v < >$), obstacles X, and empty cells (.)

- **Guards** watch in a straight line in their facing direction until blocked by a wall/obstacle or another guard. All cells in their vision are unsafe.
- The **assassin** starts at A and wants to reach the **bottom-right cell** (n-1, m-1).
- The assassin can move up/down/left/right on empty cells . only (not into obstacles, guards, or unsafe cells).
- If the assassin starts in vision or the target is unsafe/blocked, they fail.

Task: Determine if the assassin can safely reach the bottom-right cell.

2.Interview

Interview was held in virtual mode and consisted of two parts.

i)Technical interview:

Duration: 40 mins

Started with self-introduction and projects that mentioned in my resume. I was asked to explain the features of my projects and how I have implemented them. Then, the interviewer asked me about the technologies I have knowledge and practical experience on. Then I was asked to code 2 questions in Notepad while sharing my screen 1. Using any programming language, merge all the files in a folder which couldn't write the code completely but I explained the process and methods how it could be done 2. String reverse question with a little modification (reverse string word by word) which

completely successfully. Then some questions on DBMS (on concurrency related to banking transactions and I was asked write 2 simple queries: finding duplicate entries but case in-sensitive and using group by and order by to find nth largest salary), Multithreading, OOPS (polymorphism and some other questions). Then the interviewer asked about my skills and knowledge on other tech such as AI, ML, Cloud etc,.. to which I replied that I have basic knowledge on AI did a course on it but haven't done a project on. Then the interviewer finished by asking me do you have any questions.

ii)HR interview:

Duration: 55 mins

Like the technical round, it also started with self-introduction and about my projects and the interviewer specifically asked many questions on how scalable is the project, the tech stack and the reason to use that and the team work and experience on working in the project and the interview slowly drifted towards my area of interests and expertise as I was asked questions like favourite subject and subject I hate and reason to choose CSE in CEG, the technology I am currently exploring and like to learn next, a technology that I don't have in syllabus but I learnt it by myself and utilized it and liked it very much. Then some situation questions on a team project involving software development lifecycle questions and agile and other methods and my knowledge on that. I was also asked various other questions like how my team-mates describe me, my strengths and weaknesses, biggest achievement and failure, my inspiration, why Amex and why you are suitable for Amex etc,...

My advise would be think before answering and answer the behavioural and situational questions via an example from your life experiences and elaborate on it and maintain a positive attitude even when you couldn't answer completely and don't feel worried about telling them that you haven't learnt something yet. Be ambitious in your goals and sound confident. Try knowing about the company and role before the interview and it would be very useful.

Wishing you all the best for your future goals.

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